

Understanding Mild Indigestion and Dyspepsia

Indigestion (dyspepsia) involves feeling full early during a meal, uncomfortable fullness after eating, or burning in the upper abdomen.

Mild Self-Care Strategies: - Eat smaller, more frequent meals rather than large heavy meals. - Eat slowly and chew food thoroughly. - Avoid lying down for at least 2 to 3 hours after eating. - Limit trigger foods such as highly greasy, spicy, acidic, or fried items. - Avoid tight-fitting clothing around the abdomen.

Ayurvedic Dietary Context: In traditional Ayurveda, warm water (Ushnodaka) and ginger tea are traditionally used to aid digestive fire (Agni) after light meals.

Red Flags for Gastrointestinal Conditions

Seek Emergency Medical Care Immediately If You Experience: - Severe, sharp, or sudden abdominal pain. - Vomiting blood or material that looks like coffee grounds. - Black, tarry, or bloody stools. - Difficulty swallowing (dysphagia) or painful swallowing. - Unintentional significant weight loss. - Persistent vomiting preventing fluid intake.

Lifestyle Interventions for Upper GI Comfort

Practical lifestyle habits to support healthy digestion: - Elevate the head of your bed by 6 inches if experiencing night-time indigestion or acid reflux. - Maintain a comfortable, upright posture during and after meals. - Avoid heavy late-night snacks within 3 hours of bedtime.

Dietary Record & Symptom Tracking

Keeping a food and symptom journal can identify specific dietary triggers.

Journal Guidelines: - Note the time, food types, and portion sizes of each meal. - Record any mild discomfort, bloating, or fullness experienced after eating.